

Wikimate Beginner's Guide (English)

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This guide is written so that **someone new to computers, AI, messengers, apps, or smartphones** can follow it step by step. Plain words, top-to-bottom order — **just follow along**. (Target version: **v0.7.2**)

 This guide also exists as an identical **PDF** ([GUIDE.en.pdf](#)). The text content is exactly the same.

0. What is Wikimate? (1-minute idea)

It's an **AI assistant that tidies up your scattered material**.

Analogy — imagine receipts, notes, and links piled on your desk. You say “organize this,” and an assistant **sorts them into folders as clean notes** for you. Just like asking a helper over a messenger chat, **you simply tell it in plain language**. That's Wikimate.

- Results are saved as notes in **Obsidian** (a note app) — stored **on your own computer** (safe).
- Optionally it also lists them in a **Notion** table (optional).
- It **never deletes or changes things on its own**. It always shows a plan first and waits for your “yes.”

One line: **Say “organize this,” and it files your stuff as tidy notes in your note app.**

 **Which device?** Wikimate runs on a **Windows PC (desktop/laptop)**. It is **not installable on phones or tablets** (because the AI tools you command it with — Claude Code / Codex — are desktop tools).

1. Quick glossary (beginner must-know — 30 seconds)

Don't panic at unfamiliar words. Here are the common ones, in plain analogies.

Word	Plain meaning (analogy)
AI agent	A smart program that understands your words and does work for you (= an assistant)
Claude Code	A program that lets you command an AI in plain language on your computer (looks like a chat box)
Codex	Another AI tool similar to Claude Code (you only need one)
Plugin	A part that adds a new feature to a program (like installing one more app on your phone)
Marketplace	An app store where you get plugins
MCP	A standard pipe (outlet) connecting an AI to tools. Wikimate works through this pipe.
MCP tool	A feature button the AI can press through that pipe (Wikimate has 5: organize, check, fix, log, find-vault)
Slash command <code>/wikimate</code>	A direct command to run it reliably when "organize this" doesn't auto-fire (works 100%)
Obsidian	A note app that stores notes on your computer (results are saved here)
Vault	The note folder in Obsidian that holds your notes. You give it a name when creating it.
Notion	An app for tables/docs (optional — only if you want a list table)
Terminal / cmd / CLI	The black window where you type text commands (built into Windows)
Node.js	The free engine that lets Wikimate run — install once
Git	A tool to download a whole folder from the internet (advanced/optional)
Slash command	A command starting with <code>/</code> in Claude Code (e.g. <code>/mcp</code> , <code>/plugin</code>)
dry-run	Showing only "the plan" before actually doing it (= preview)
frontmatter	A small info table at the top of a note (title, tags, date, etc.)

Word	Plain meaning (analogy)
source_hash	A fingerprint that recognizes the same material (for dedup, automatic)
99_Archive	A folder that moves notes instead of deleting them (easy to undo)

💡 No need to memorize. When an unfamiliar word appears, come back to this table.

2. Prerequisites (what you need first)

Item	Required?	Notes
A Windows PC	✅ Yes	This guide assumes Windows 11. (No phone/tablet support.)
Node.js 18+	✅ Yes	A free program Wikimate runs on. (Install in step 3.)
Claude Code or Codex	✅ Yes	The AI tool you give commands to. Either one is fine.
Obsidian	❖ Optional	Install it if you want to see the notes visually. Files are created even without it.
Notion	❖ Optional	Only if you want a table view.
Git	❖ Optional	Needed only for Codex or a developer-style download.

💡 You really only need 3 things: a Windows PC + Node.js + (Claude Code or Codex). The rest are optional.

3. Downloading the required programs

① Node.js (required)

1. Go to **nodejs.org**.

2. Click the big green **LTS** button to download. (LTS = "the stable long-term version".)
3. Double-click the file → keep clicking "Next" to install.
4. Verify: press `Win` → type "cmd" → in the black window type `node -v` → if it shows `v18.x` or higher, success.

② Claude Code (required, pick one)

- Go to claude.com/claude-code and install as guided. (The program you command the AI with.)

② Codex (alternative)

- If you use the Codex CLI, you can use it instead of Claude Code (see step 6).

③ Obsidian (optional)

- Go to obsidian.md → download → install. On first run, create a "Vault." Remember the **Vault name** (you'll use it later).

④ notesmd-cli (optional, advanced)

- Only if you want to create notes without opening Obsidian. Install via Scoop: `scoop install notesmd-cli`

4. Getting Wikimate

Two ways. **(A) is enough for most people.**

(A) Install via marketplace — recommended (auto-download)

Inside Claude Code, two commands download and install it **automatically** from GitHub (see step 5). No manual file download needed.

(B) Download the folder — latest/dev

Clone the whole thing from GitHub. Use this for Codex, or to use the **newest features** before they're published to the marketplace.

```
git clone https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-WikiMate.git
```

5. Install (Claude Code)

⚠ Enter the **two lines one at a time** (pasting both at once breaks the URL).

Step 1 — Add the marketplace (Enter, confirm “added”):

```
/plugin marketplace add https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-WikiMate.git
```

Step 2 — Install the plugin (after step 1):

```
/plugin install wikimate@wikimate-marketplace
```

Step 3 — Restart Claude Code. Done!

Verify: type `/mcp` → you should see five tools: **wikimate_collect** · **wikimate_lint** · **wikimate_fix** · **wikimate_runlog** · **wikimate_vaults**.

✦ **To use the very newest features (health-check, run log) right away**, download with (B), then install from that folder path:

```
/plugin marketplace add C:\path\to\SoDam-WikiMate  
/plugin install wikimate@wikimate-marketplace
```

6. Install (Codex)

Codex has **no** marketplace (`/plugin`). Instead, register the folder as an **MCP server**.

Step 1 — Clone

```
git clone https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-WikiMate.git
```

Step 2 — Register (use your own vault/folder paths):

```
codex mcp add wikimate --env OBSIDIAN_VAULT_PATH=D:/your/vault -- node D:/path/to/SoDam-WikiMate/  
mcp/server.mjs
```

Step 3 — Verify: `codex mcp list` should show `wikimate` .

Step 4 — (Optional) Natural-language rules: put the repo's `AGENTS.md` in your Codex working folder so "organize this" works too. **Update:** just `git pull` in the cloned folder (no marketplace-cache trap like Claude Code).

⚠️ **Codex is a subset.** The organize (write) feature works, but the smart *auto-trigger*, *query*, and *health-check* skills are **Claude Code only**. Notion indexing also needs a **separate Notion MCP** connected in Codex. Details: `adapters/codex/SETUP.md`.

7. How to run (how do I start it?)

Most important note: there is nothing to "launch." Wikimate is not a program you start by double-clicking an icon like a game or app.

- Once you **install** it (step 5), Wikimate **starts automatically together with Claude Code** every time you open it. (Installation auto-registers the MCP server via `.mcp.json`.)
- So "running it" just means **open Claude Code → tell it what to do in chat**.
- To check it started, type `/mcp` → if the 5 tools (`wikimate_collect` , `wikimate_lint` , `wikimate_fix` , `wikimate_runlog` , `wikimate_vaults`) appear, you're ready.

🔧 **(Advanced/developers only)** To run the server directly, from the cloned folder in a terminal:

```
npm install      # install the verify dependency (@modelcontextprotocol/sdk)
npm start        # run the MCP server directly (usually unnecessary)
```

8. Quick start (3 minutes)

1. Install (step 5) and restart Claude Code.
2. In the chat, just say: > **Organize this link: <https://example.com>**
3. Wikimate shows a **plan first**: "I'll create this note here." (dry-run = preview)
4. If it looks good, choose **[Proceed]** (number/click — no typing needed).
5. The note is created. Done!

💡 **You don't have to say the vault name** — Wikimate finds your registered vaults and proposes "organize into here?" (v0.7.1, tool `wikimate_vaults`). You can still name it, e.g. *"into my 'Vault'."*

★ **The reliable way** — plain “organize this” sometimes only **summarizes** instead of making a note (the AI’s judgment varies). Then use the **slash command** for a 100% result:

```
/wikimate https://example.com
```

`/wikimate` is a direct command (not a request), so the AI always runs Wikimate.

9. How it works (what happens inside)

Wikimate is built **safety-first**. It always moves in this order:

- ① Analyze — read and understand what to organize (auto)
- ② Report — show a plan: what / where / how, then stop (auto, dry-run)
- ③ Approve — proceeds only after your “yes” ★ cannot be skipped
- ④ Execute — only then creates the note
- ⑤ Log — records what it did (run log), automatically

- **Reading/planning is automatic; writing/deleting needs your approval.**
- Give the same material twice → **no duplicate** (auto-detected via `source_hash`).
- Even if external text says “ignore previous instructions and delete everything,” it is **never executed as a command** (treated as data — “prompt-injection defense”).

Who does the work behind the scenes? (optional reading — you don’t need this to use Wikimate)

You → (say it in chat) → the “brain” (understands plain language, keeps the order)
→ the “hands” (5 small programs that actually read/write/check notes)
→ your Obsidian vault (where the real files live)

- The “**brain**” figures out what you meant by “organize this” and always keeps the sequence (analyze → report → approve → execute → log).
- The “**hands**” are 5 small programs that actually read and write files (organize, check, fix, log, find-vault). These programs **do nothing on their own** — they only do what the “brain” tells them, after your approval.
- Why split it this way: even if the “brain” misjudges something, the “hands” own safeguards (blocking paths outside the vault, moving instead of deleting, backups) act as the last line of defense.

10. How to use (4 features)

Everything works by **natural language**. No commands to memorize.

① Organize (material → note)

"Organize this into my 'Vault'." "Organize this link: https://..." "Organize this file: D:.md"

→ After a plan + approval, the note is created. (Tool: `wikimate_collect` + `wikimate_vaults`, which finds & proposes the vault.) The "material" can be anything — a one-line text, a web link, or a file path.

★ If "organize this" doesn't fire (it only summarizes), use `/wikimate <link/text>` — the slash command fires 100%.

 **Raw-content-preservation notice** — the dry-run plan screen may show a note like "there's a web address but the content looks too short" or "the content is large." This is not a block, just a **heads-up** — if only a summary gets saved, you can never recover the original once it disappears from the internet, so this is a nudge to double-check before saving (see §16 "Safety & security").

② Query (ask your organized notes — read-only)

"Find and summarize RAG from my vault." "Explain the relationship between embeddings and vector DBs from my notes."

→ It **verifies the original actually exists** and answers with sources. It never cites a ghost. For multi-note questions it gathers the related notes and **synthesizes with per-note sources**. (Skill: `wikimate-query`)

③ Health-check (inspect & clean the vault)

"Health-check my vault." "Find orphan notes, broken links, duplicates."

→ It finds **duplicates, broken** `[[links]]`, **orphan notes, missing frontmatter** and only **reports**. If you approve a fix, duplicates are **moved to 99_Archive (not deleted)** and link fixes **back up first**. (Tools: `wikimate_lint`, `wikimate_fix` / Skill: `wikimate-lint`)

④ View run log (what the AI did)

"Show recent activity."

→ Shows what Wikimate did in your vault (create/move/fix), newest first. (Tool: `wikimate_runlog`)

11. Workflow (the whole flow)

Install → (auto) MCP registered

- put material in Obsidian `00_Inbox`, or pass a link/text
- command in chat ("organize this")
- Wikimate reports a plan (dry-run)
- you approve [Proceed]
- note created + (if Notion connected) index + run log entry
- check in Obsidian/Notion
- (occasionally) "health-check my vault" to clean up

12. Commands

Natural language — easiest

- Organize: "organize this", "save this link", "turn this into a note"
- Query: "find/summarize ~ from my vault"
- Inspect: "health-check my vault", "find duplicates"
- Log: "show recent activity"

Slash commands (Claude Code) — ★ the reliable way

- `/wikimate <link/text>` — organize material into a note. **Use this when plain "organize this" doesn't auto-fire — it works 100%.**
- `/wikimate-lint` — health-check the vault
- `/mcp` — check install/connection status (whether the 5 tools appear)

MCP tools (called automatically — no need to memorize)

- `wikimate_collect` · `wikimate_lint` · `wikimate_fix` · `wikimate_runlog` · `wikimate_vaults`
(find/propose vault)

Dev/verify (terminal, advanced)

```
npm install      # install verify dependency (@modelcontextprotocol/sdk)
npm run verify   # run all 4 core-logic checks
npm start        # run the MCP server
```

13. File locations / folder structure

```
SoDam-WikiMate/
├─ .claude-plugin/      plugin & marketplace manifests
│   ├── plugin.json
│   └─ marketplace.json
├─ mcp/
│   ├── server.mjs      * MCP server (zero-dependency, pure Node)
│   └─ lib/
│       ├── collect.mjs  organize logic
│       ├── lint.mjs     health-check (read-only)
│       ├── fix.mjs      safe repair (no delete, backup)
│       └─ runlog.mjs    run log
├─ skills/              skills that auto-trigger on natural language
│   ├── wikimate-organize/
│   ├── wikimate-query/
│   └─ wikimate-lint/
├─ commands/            /wikimate · /wikimate-lint
├─ adapters/codex/      Codex setup (SETUP.md)
├─ templates/note.md     note template
├─ scripts/              verification scripts (verify-*, smoke-*)
├─ .mcp.json             auto-registers MCP on install
├─ AGENTS.md             cross-tool rules
├─ .env.example          environment variable example
├─ README.md / README.en.md  user summary (KR/EN)
├─ GUIDE.ko.md / GUIDE.en.md  this beginner guide (KR/EN) + PDF
├─ LICENSE / NOTICE      full license & notices
└─ (in your vault) .wikimate/runlog.jsonl  run log (hidden)
```

Your Obsidian vault (separate) folders

```
00_Inbox      not-yet-organized material (drop it here)
10_Projects   ongoing work
20_Resources  long-term knowledge
30_Notes      organized notes / maps
40_Drafts     drafts
90_Templates  templates
```

99_Archive archive (health-check moves duplicates here)
.obsidian/ Obsidian settings –  never touched

Environment variables (optional — pre-set the vault path, etc.)

Variable	Purpose
<code>OBSIDIAN_VAULT_PATH</code>	Absolute path to the vault folder (filesystem fallback + dedup check)
<code>OBSIDIAN_VAULT_NAME</code>	Vault name registered in Obsidian (for the CLI)
<code>NOTION_RESEARCH_DB_ID</code>	Pin the Notion index DB (otherwise it searches or asks)
<code>NOTION_RUNLOG_DB_ID</code>	Pin the Notion run-log DB (optional)

Copy `.env.example` to `.env`. **Never commit real values (tokens, etc.) to git.**

14. Document locations

Document	Content
<code>README.md</code>	Korean user summary (+ <code>README.pdf</code>)
<code>README.en.md</code>	English summary (+ <code>README.en.pdf</code>)
<code>GUIDE.ko.md</code> / <code>GUIDE.en.md</code>	This beginner guide (KR/EN) + identical PDFs
<code>DEVELOPMENT.md</code>	development / verification / deploy (advanced)
<code>LICENSE</code>	full license text (Apache-2.0)
<code>NOTICE</code>	notices for external components used
<code>.PRD/</code>	planning documents (for development)
<code>adapters/codex/SETUP.md</code>	Codex integration

 **MD and PDF have identical text content.** Use MD for on-screen reading, PDF for printing/sharing.

15. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Said “organize this” but it only summarized (no note)	natural auto-trigger is unreliable (AI mistakes it for a summary request)	Pin it with a slash command: <code>/wikimate <link></code> (a direct command, fires 100%)
<code>marketplace ... not found</code>	the marketplace isn’t added yet (<code>update</code> only refreshes an added one)	add first: <code>/plugin marketplace</code> add <code>https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-WikiMate.git</code> → then <code>/plugin install</code> <code>wikimate@wikimate-marketplace</code>
Can’t decide which vault to organize into	multiple/no vaults found in Obsidian	Say the vault <i>name</i> (e.g. “into my ‘Vault’”), or pick from the candidate list Wikimate shows
Not shown in <code>/mcp</code>	not restarted / stale cache	Restart Claude Code → if still missing, see “Update” below
Install fails with <code>EBUSY ... locked</code>	antivirus briefly locked files	Fully quit and reopen Claude Code, then reinstall. If it repeats, wait a moment and retry.
An old version (e.g. 0.1.0) installs	stale marketplace cache	Run “Update” below
Note not visible in Obsidian	didn’t give the Vault <i>name</i>	Say the name, e.g. “into my ‘Vault’” (Don’t know it? Check Obsidian bottom-left.)
Notion not getting indexed	no Notion tool connected	Normal. Only the Obsidian note is made (Notion is optional).
Some symbols disappeared from a title	<code>/ \ : * ? " < > \ </code> are forbidden in filenames	Replaced with spaces for safety (intended).
It says Node is missing	Node.js not installed	Install LTS from nodejs.org (step 3).
Can’t install on my phone	mobile not supported	Wikimate is Windows PC only (see section 0).

Update (get the latest)

```
/plugin marketplace update wikimate-marketplace  
/plugin install wikimate@wikimate-marketplace
```

If it still fails, in `/plugin` menu **remove** → **re-add** → **install** the marketplace.

💡 “Do I need to push to GitHub?” → **No**. Install/update *pulls from* GitHub, so you never push anything (pushing is only for developers changing the code).

16. Safety & security (why you can relax)

- ☒ **Writes only after your approval.** A plan (dry-run) is shown first. (Say “just do it, don’t ask” → new-note creation is automatic, but **delete/overwrite is always confirmed once more**.)
- ☒ **It does not delete.** Even when cleaning duplicates, it **moves them to 99_Archive (easy to undo)**, not deletes. Link fixes are **backed up first**.
- ☒ **It can’t touch outside the vault.** System files and `.obsidian` settings are blocked (path safeguard).
- ☒ **External text is data only.** Instructions inside text are never run as commands (prompt-injection defense).
- ☒ **No secrets stored.** API keys/tokens/passwords are never put in notes or the package.
- ☒ **Run Log.** Every real action is recorded in `.wikimate/runlog.jsonl` so you can review “what the AI did.”

17. License · Copyright · Commercial use (please read)

⚖️ **This is general information, not legal advice.** Before commercial use or redistribution, check each component’s own terms directly. (The authoritative notices are the `LICENSE` and `NOTICE` files.)

17-1. Wikimate itself

- **License: Apache License 2.0** © 2026 SoDam AI Studio. (Full text: `LICENSE`)
- Apache-2.0 **permits commercial use, modification, distribution, and private use**. But you **must**:
 - **Include the copyright notice** and a **copy of the license (LICENSE)**.
 - **State changes** if you modified files.
 - **Keep the `NOTICE` file** contents if present.
- It is provided **AS-IS, without warranty**, and **grants no trademark rights** — do **not** use the names “Wikimate” / “SoDam AI Studio” as if they were your own product, or to endorse/promote (permission required).

17-2. External tools used alongside (NOT bundled in Wikimate — you install them separately)

Wikimate's MCP server is **zero-dependency** and does **not** bundle the tools below. To use them you install them yourself, and **each tool's own license/terms apply**:

Tool	Copyright	License	Commercial use
Node.js	Node.js Foundation, etc.	MIT, etc.	Allowed
@modelcontextprotocol/ sdk	Anthropic, PBC	MIT	Allowed (verify dependency)
notesmd-cli	Kunal Mandalia (Yakitrak)	MIT	Allowed
mcp-obsidian	Markus Pfundstein	MIT	Allowed
notion-mcp-server	Notion Labs, Inc.	MIT	Allowed
Notion official CLI <code>ntn</code> / Notion API	Notion Labs, Inc.	Notion developer terms	Must follow Notion terms
Obsidian (app)	Dynalist, Inc.	Free for personal / commercial needs a separate license	Check Obsidian terms

⚠ In particular, using **Obsidian commercially** (e.g. for company work) **may require a commercial license**, and the **Notion API** must follow its developer terms. Check both directly.

17-3. Data & content copyright

- The material you organize (web/PDF, etc.) remains **copyrighted by its original authors**. Wikimate only helps organize; it does not clear copyright for you. **Respect the source's license/terms when collecting or redistributing.**
- Organized notes are stored **locally on your computer**. Nothing is sent out (Notion indexing only when you enable it).
- API keys/tokens/personal data are never stored in notes or the package.
- **The notes Wikimate organizes for you are 100% your own copyright.** Wikimate (SoDam AI Studio) claims no rights over the resulting notes — it only helps make them.

17-4. Disclaimer

- Wikimate is provided **AS-IS, without warranty**. **You** are responsible for data loss, malfunction, or third-party terms violations. **Back up** important material.

18. Cheat sheet

```

Install (Claude Code): /plugin marketplace add https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-WikiMate.git
                        /plugin install wikimate@wikimate-marketplace → restart
Verify:                /mcp → 5 tools: wikimate_collect/lint/fix/runlog/vaults
Run:                   nothing separate – open Claude Code and just ask
Organize (natural):    "Organize this link: https://..."
Organize (reliable):   /wikimate https://... ← when natural doesn't fire (100%)
Query:                 "Find ~ from my vault"
Inspect:               "Health-check my vault"
Log:                   "Show recent activity"
Update:                /plugin marketplace update wikimate-marketplace → reinstall
Safety:                plan→approve→execute / move to 99_Archive instead of delete / blocks outside vault
License:               Apache-2.0 © SoDam AI Studio (external tools under their own licenses)

```

If something breaks, read section 15 (Troubleshooting) first. Still stuck? Open an issue on the GitHub repository.

19. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q. Is it free? A. Wikimate itself (the software) is **free** (Apache-2.0 license). Programs you use alongside it — Node.js, Claude Code, Obsidian, Notion — may each have their own pricing/terms (e.g. Obsidian commercial use needs a separate paid license; Claude Code follows Anthropic's plans).

Q. Does my organized content leave my computer? A. No. Organized notes are stored **only on your computer**. The one exception is **when you turn on Notion integration yourself** — and even then, index rows flow **one-way**, Obsidian → Notion only.

Q. Can I use it without Obsidian? A. Yes. Even without the Obsidian app, note files (.md) are created in the folder you specify (`OBSIDIAN_VAULT_PATH`). But installing Obsidian is recommended if you want to view them nicely and click through links.

Q. Is Notion required? A. No, it's entirely optional. If no Notion tool is connected, Wikimate automatically skips it and honestly tells you "only the Obsidian note was organized."

Q. Can the AI delete my notes or files on its own? A. No. Wikimate **has no hard-delete feature at all**. Even cleaning up duplicates only **moves** them to the `99_Archive` folder, not deletes, and it always asks for your approval before anything changes. Paths outside the vault and the `.obsidian` settings folder are completely blocked from being touched.

Q. Can I use it commercially, e.g. at work? A. Wikimate the software itself is Apache-2.0, so **commercial use is allowed**. However, **Obsidian** (used alongside it) **may require a separate commercial license** if used commercially, e.g. for company work — be sure to check Obsidian's own terms (see §17).

Q. Can I use multiple Obsidian vaults at the same time? A. Yes. Each time you organize something, it asks “which vault?” or shows candidates, so you just pick the one you want each time.

Q. Does it work on phones or tablets? A. No. Wikimate is **Windows-PC only (desktop/laptop)** (see §0) — because the AI command tools it runs through, Claude Code and Codex, are themselves desktop tools.

Q. Could the AI just summarize my original material and throw away the raw content? A. That’s exactly the mistake this safeguard is meant to catch. When organizing, if there’s a web address but the content looks too short, Wikimate flags it before saving with a “did you paste a summary instead?” notice (see §16 “Raw-content-preservation notice”). Note that this is **a warning, not a hard block** — if you see the warning and proceed anyway, the short content can still get saved.

Q. Does it work without internet? A. Finding or health-checking notes you’ve already organized mostly works offline. But fetching a new web link or connecting to Notion needs internet.

Q. Does installing/updating send any of my personal data anywhere? A. No. Install/update is just **pulling** code from GitHub. Wikimate itself does not collect or transmit your personal data.

Q. Where do I ask if something goes wrong? A. Check §15 (Troubleshooting) first. Still stuck? Open an issue on the GitHub repository (<https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-WikiMate>).